

Paresh Maity stands next to his sculpture, 'Equilibrium'

Q+A

A Fine Balance

WITH A SCULPTURE ON VIEW IN VENICE AND ARTWORK ADORNING THE NEW NOIDA AIRPORT, ARTIST PARESH MAITY HAS A FULL PALETTE

Q. *What is your sculpture 'Equilibrium', on display in Venice, all about?*

'Equilibrium', presented by Art Alive Gallery at Marinaressa Gardens, Venice, explores the idea of balance as the fundamental force that sustains life and the universe. Through a strong geometric and monumental form, it reflects the delicate relationship between different energies.

Q. *What informs your artistic practice?*

Nature is my greatest inspiration. I believe that nature is present in every aspect of life and the closer we are to it, the richer our understanding of the world becomes. As Aristotle said, art is an imitation of nature and I truly believe there is nothing we can imagine beyond it.

Q. *You have done the public art for the Noida airport as well. Tell us a bit about some of the major pieces there.*

Yes, for the newly inaugurated Noida International Airport at Jewar, I created two major public artworks. The first is 'Jagriti' (Awakening), an 8x100-foot painting inspired by the ancient Indian concept of Sadanga, or the six limbs of art. The second work is 'Mystic Abode', a large-scale immersive installation comprising over 8,500 brass bells. Together, these artworks aim to create moments of inspiration and discovery within the airport environment.

Q. *What else are you working on?*

I am currently working on several major projects. One of them is an 8x100-foot painting inspired by Varanasi, a city I have been visiting for over four decades. I am also working on a large-scale, 40-foot painting of Dal Lake in Kashmir. Over the years, I have been deeply captivated by its beauty and this work seeks to capture its atmosphere and changing moods through an impressionistic visual language.

—with ***Amit Dixit***